

The Rotten Fencepost™ Training 001

COMPLETE PARTICIPANT PACKAGE Why Do I Keep Starting Over? Find What Keeps Undoing Your Progress

Kahu Phil Stephens • Rotten Fencepost Publishing

START HERE

This is a self-guided training. Carry one real recurring problem through the sessions. The purpose is not to collect information. The purpose is to learn how to inspect a recurring problem, act on what the evidence shows, prepare for pressure, and return without automatically starting from zero.

NOTICE → TRACE → INSPECT → TEST → DECIDE → REBUILD → PREPARE → RECOVER → MAINTAIN

WHAT YOU WILL KEEP

- Restart Cycle Map
- Symptom/Cause Inspection
- Backward Trace
- Ground & Pressure Inspection
- Repair Decision
- Wind Plan
- Setback Recovery Plan
- Continuing Fence Walk
- Reusable Rotten Fencepost™ Fence Inspection Record

SESSIONS 1–3 — YOUR FIRST INSPECTION

Complete the free beginning first. Bring your Restart Cycle Map, Symptom/Cause Inspection, Backward Trace, suspected weak point, and seven-day observations into Session 4.

SESSION 4 — INSPECT THE GROUND AROUND THE POST

Finding a possible cause is not the same as proving it. A good inspection tests the suspected weak point against what actually happens.

What pressures repeatedly show up before the pattern weakens?

What in my environment makes the old pattern easier?

What does my plan assume about time, energy, money, motivation, or support?

What needs to be prepared before the difficult moment arrives?

What help is appropriate, and what responsibility remains mine?

Was the structure broken, or did I stop maintaining something that had been working?

TEST THE SUSPECTED CAUSE

My suspected weak point is:

Evidence that supports this:

Evidence that does NOT fit this explanation:

What I will observe before I decide:

If the evidence does not support your first explanation, that is useful. You have eliminated a bad diagnosis.

SESSION 5 — REPAIR, REPLACE, REINFORCE, OR MAINTAIN

Not every weak fence needs the same response.

REPAIR

Repair a limited failure when the larger structure remains sound.

What specifically needs repair?

REPLACE

Replace a pattern, expectation, structure, or approach when the evidence shows it repeatedly cannot carry the load.

What may need replacement rather than another patch?

REINFORCE

Reinforce a basically sound plan when predictable pressure repeatedly overwhelms it.

What support, preparation, boundary, reminder, environment change, or simplification could reinforce it?

MAINTAIN

Maintain what works when the real problem is that continuing attention stopped.

What regular maintenance keeps this sound?

My present decision is REPAIR / REPLACE / REINFORCE / MAINTAIN:

The evidence for that decision is:

The smallest meaningful action that follows is:

SESSION 6 — BUILD FOR THE DAY THE WIND BLOWS

Many plans are built for a day with enough sleep, time, money, motivation, and no surprises. Then ordinary life arrives. A fence is not built only for a calm afternoon.

The predictable pressure most likely to weaken this plan is:

The earliest warning sign is:

YOUR WIND PLAN

WHEN this happens:

I WILL do this:

If that is not possible, my minimum safe version is:

What could prevent me from using this plan?

How I will make the response easier to use:

What evidence will tell me whether it helped:

THE MINIMUM THAT STILL COUNTS

On a strong day, my normal action is:

On a hard day, the minimum action that preserves continuity is:

Smaller is not the same as zero.

SESSION 7 — STOP STARTING FROM ZERO

A setback may reveal a weak point, a pressure you did not prepare for, a repair that did not work, or maintenance that stopped. It does not automatically prove that everything you built has disappeared.

A bent wire is not automatically a rotten fence.

SETBACK RECOVERY PLAN

What happened?

What still remains sound?

What actually failed?

Was this a new problem or the return of an old pressure?

Repair, replace, reinforce, or maintain?

What is the next useful action—not the next grand restart?

REBUILDING SELF-TRUST

Self-trust is rebuilt by evidence: notice what happened, make an honest decision, take the next action, and return when you slip.

One promise small enough that I can actually keep it is:

How I will know I kept it:

When I will inspect again:

THE CONTINUING FENCE WALK

Keep the process. When another recurring problem appears, walk the fence again.

NOTICE → TRACE → INSPECT → TEST → DECIDE → REBUILD → PREPARE → RECOVER → MAINTAIN

INDEPENDENT SECOND FENCE INSPECTION

Choose a different recurring problem and make a shorter inspection without copying your first answers.

1. What keeps happening?

2. What is the visible symptom?

3. What happened before it?

4. What weak point or pressure deserves inspection?

5. What evidence supports or challenges that explanation?

6. Repair, replace, reinforce, or maintain?

7. What is my Wind Plan?

8. If I slip, what will I preserve and what will I repair?

9. When will I inspect again?

If you can use the process on a second problem, you are no longer merely learning the Rotten Fencepost™ Principle. You are learning to use it.

REUSABLE ROTTEN FENCEPOST™ FENCE INSPECTION RECORD

A — NOTICE

What keeps happening?

What visible event gets my attention?

B — TRACE

What happened immediately before it?

What happened before that?

C — INSPECT

What pressures or conditions surround it?

What keeps weakening the same place?

D — TEST

What evidence supports my suspected cause?

What evidence does not fit?

E — DECIDE

Repair, replace, reinforce, or maintain?

Why?

F — REBUILD

What is the smallest meaningful action?

What needs to change around it so it can survive?

G — PREPARE

What predictable wind is coming?

WHEN ____ happens, I WILL _____. My minimum safe version is _____.

H — RECOVER

If I slip, what remains sound?

What needs repair, and what is my next useful action?

I — MAINTAIN

What regular maintenance does this require?

When will I inspect again?

IMPORTANT

This training is educational and reflective. It does not diagnose or treat medical or mental-health conditions and does not replace appropriate medical, mental-health, financial, legal, pastoral, or other professional assistance.